CONTRIBUTION OF NAM

The NAM, which was born in the backdrop of the Cold War tensions between the two superpowers, worked for peace, security, disarmament, independence, development and cooperation among nations. In short, it can be said that NAM's contribution can be best assessed in terms of six Ds—Decolonization, Détente, Disarmament, Development, Democratization and Dissemination.

From its inception, the Movement primarily focused on peace and disarmament and the need for peaceful coexistence among states. There was also a strong support for freedom struggle against the colonial rule in Algeria, Angola, Tunisia, South Africa and Cuba. The process of decolonization also received support and attention in Mozambique and other Portuguese colonies, French Somaliland, Southern Rhodesia, Aden and Oman. The Movement vehemently criticized the apartheid in South Africa and even went to the extent of breaking off diplomatic ties with South Africa.

In the economic front, the NAM drew attention to the rising neo-colonialism, and in the Lusaka Summit it was stated that "classical colonialism is trying to perpetuate itself in the garb of neo-colonialism —a less obvious, but in no way a less dangerous means of economic and political domination over the developing countries". Therefore, the NAM demanded a revision of the unequal global economic structure with a New International Economic Order based on equity and justice.

As far as the institutionalization of NAM was concerned, a major resolution was adopted in the Colombo Summit with the composition and mandate of the Coordinating Bureau. Another important step was the setting up of the Press Agencies Pool of non-aligned countries with a view to foster cooperation in the field of information and mass media and set up a New World Information and Communication Order (NWICO) also known as New International Information Order. The NAM also highlighted the need for collective self-reliance among the developing countries, which would augment their development and help in the establishment of New International Economic Order (NIEO). In other words, it sought a South–South